7-Day Songwriting Sprint

A Printable Workbook to Write and Finish One Song in a Week

Welcome

Most songs never get finished. This workbook gives you **20 to 40 minutes a day for 7 days** and a clear job each day. By Day 7 you will have a complete demo-ready song.

What you need: a pen or notes app, your phone's voice recorder, and any instrument (or just your voice).

Rules

- Finish each day, even if it is rough.
- No editing before Day 6.
- Record everything on your phone.

Day 1: Find the Idea (20 min)

Goal: Pick one song idea.

1. Write 10 things you felt this week (one line each).
2. Circle the 3 strongest.
3. For each, answer: *What happened? Who was there? What did I want to say but didn't?*
4. Choose one. Write it as a single sentence:

> This song is about _____ and the feeling is _____.

Checklist: [ ] 10 feelings [ ] 3 circled [ ] 1 sentence

Day 2: Write the Hook (30 min)

Goal: Create your title and chorus idea.

1. Write 20 possible titles (2 to 7 words). Do not judge.
2. Pick the one you can imagine repeated.
3. Speak the title in 5 different rhythms. Record the one that sticks.
4. Hum 3 melodies for it. Record the best.

Hook test

- [ ] Short enough to sing in one breath
- [ ] One clear emotion
- [ ] Repeating it doesn't get boring

Day 3: Build the Chords (30 min)

Goal: Pick a progression and a feel.

Common progressions (in any major key)

Feel	Progression (Roman numerals)	In C major
Uplifting	I – V – vi – IV	C – G – Am – F
Nostalgic	vi – IV – I – V	Am – F – C – G
Emotional	vi – V – IV – V	Am – G – F – G
Classic rock	I – IV – V – IV	C – F – G – F
Smooth/Jazzy	ii – V – I – vi	Dm – G – C – Am
Dark	i – VI – III – VII	Am – F – C – G (minor feel)

1. Choose one progression for the chorus.
2. Choose a different one (or the same with a new rhythm) for the verse.
3. Play it for 5 minutes and sing your hook over it.
4. Record a 1-minute loop.

Day 4: Verse 1 and Verse 2 (40 min)

Goal: Tell the story.

Verse 1 = Setting. Where are we? Who is here? Use 3 concrete details (objects, sounds, places).

Verse 2 = Change. What changed or got worse? Add one detail that surprises.

Detail prompts

- What was on the table / floor / radio?
- What time was it?
- What did they say exactly?
- What did you do with your hands?

Rhyme scheme options: ABAB, AABB, ABCB (easiest and most natural: lines 2 and 4 rhyme).

Checklist: [ ] Verse 1 (4 to 8 lines) [ ] Verse 2 (4 to 8 lines) [ ] Recorded rough take

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Day 5: Pre-Chorus and Bridge (30 min)

Goal: Add lift and a twist.

Pre-chorus: 2 to 4 lines that build tension. Raise the melody, shorten the lines, or end on an unresolved chord.

Bridge: Change one thing: perspective, chord, rhythm, or time. Say the thing you haven't said yet.

Bridge starters

- "But what if…"
- "Years from now…"
- "I never told you…"
- "If I could go back…"

Day 6: Edit (30 min)

Goal: Make it better, not longer.

The 6-pass edit

1. **Cut** any line that doesn't serve the title.
2. **Swap** abstract words for concrete ones ("sadness" becomes "the dishes still in the sink").
3. **Check** rhythm: read aloud and mark stressed syllables.
4. **Check** rhyme: remove forced rhymes. Near rhymes are fine.
5. **Check** perspective: stay consistent (I/you/we).
6. **Check** the first line and last line. They carry the most weight.

Day 7: Record and Finish (40 min)

Goal: Record a complete demo.

1. Warm up your voice for 5 minutes.
2. Record the whole song in one take. Don't stop for mistakes.
3. Record a second take if you want.
4. Name the file: `YYYY-MM-DD_Title_Demo`.
5. Share it with one person.

You finished a song. Repeat with a new idea.

Appendix A: Song Structure Templates

Structure	Use for
Verse – Chorus – Verse – Chorus – Bridge – Chorus	Most pop/rock/country
Verse – Verse – Bridge – Verse	Folk/storytelling
Intro – Verse – Pre – Chorus – Verse – Pre – Chorus – Drop – Chorus	Electronic/dance pop
Hook – Verse – Hook – Verse – Hook	Hip-hop

Appendix B: 30 Writing Prompts (one per day for a month)

1. A text you almost sent
2. The last time you cried laughing
3. A place that no longer exists
4. A lie everyone believes
5. What your grandparents never said
6. A fight in a parked car
7. A first apartment
8. A song you can't listen to anymore
9. A phone call at 3 AM
10. A goodbye at an airport
11. Being the youngest in the room
12. The smell of a childhood house
13. A promise you broke
14. A promise you kept
15. A secret you carry well

16. The cost of being brave
17. A stranger who changed your day
18. A road trip that went wrong
19. An old photo
20. What you do when nobody is watching
21. A gift that meant too much
22. Moving cities
23. Your worst haircut
24. Waiting for results
25. The end of summer
26. A friend you lost
27. Becoming your parent
28. An apology you never got
29. What home means now
30. The day you decided to start

Appendix C: Quick Rhyme Help

- **Perfect:** day/stay, night/light
- **Near:** home/alone, time/mine, heart/dark
- **Multisyllable:** remember/December, hesitate/celebrate
- **Internal:** put a rhyme in the middle of a line for energy.

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